underneath clothes; three zealous recruits in Padma, Bhagyanathan and Nalini; and a mentor, Sundaram. The stage was set.

Suddenly Kaarthikeyan arrived on the interrogation scene. He shifted Nalini and Murugan to a bigger room, where all the key officers of the SIT—Kanth, Raju, Verma, Sri Kumar, Ragothaman and he—would jointly question the assassins. Bhagyanathan was also brought in. The officers made all three—Nalini, Murugan and Bhagyanathan—face one another. They might have been dedicated soldiers of the LTTE but were closely related to each other. Murugan was married to Nalini, who was Bhagyanathan's sister. Facing the interrogation together was going to be an emotional hassle too.

The interrogators changed their tactics. None of them acted tough. The shift in attitude confused the suspects. Why were Raju, Kanth and Verma asking them questions like if they had eaten properly or if anyone was feeling tired? Murugan, with this military training, understood the SIT was now applying new interrogation techniques. He knew he could not resist the interrogators beyond a point. And that time had come. So he tried to make it easy for the interrogators. He told them that Sivarasan had landed in Madras in early March. The mastermind of the plot stayed at the first hideout run by Payas in Porur. Subramaniam and Muthuraja came there to greet him and brief him on the new recruits—Bhagyanathan's family.

This was the beginning of Sivarasan's mission of killing Rajiv Gandhi on Indian soil. He took charge of executing it. Things worked according to plan. Being an expert on arms and explosives himself, Sivarasan studied the design of the bomb and appreciated Peraribalan's work. He thanked Subramaniam and Muthuraja for finding the right recruits and advised them to return to Jaffna—staying in India would not be safe thereafter. They did as told.

Nalini added that Sivarasan moved to her place and discussed the plan with Murugan, her and her brother Bhagyanathan. Her mother Padma knew what was going on but didn't join the meetings regularly. Sivarasan told them that he had somebody in mind who could act as the human bomb for the final strike. He never mentioned the target, though.[13]